

Old Testament





About the Course

From 7th grade through high school, students read through the OT chronologically. For 2026-2027 they read 2 Samuel-I Kings, 1 & 2 Chronicles, Psalms and Proverbs (selections) and Ecclesiastes. 12th grade will also read Song of Solomon. With the aid of study Bible notes and selections from study helps such as the Old Testament Today or The Bible Project, this course allows students to meditate on Scripture and engage with the historical and cultural context of the Bible when it was written, as well as the way the OT continues to be relevant as God's word today.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Bible: Grades 7-8, Bible: Grade 9, Bible: Grades 10-11, Bible: Grade 12



Placement & Combining Tips

Students in Grades 7-12 read the same passages of Scripture, but the lesson plans include a variety of discussion questions and extra study helps differentiated by grade to help students engage at various depths. This makes these lessons flexible for individual students and/or a multi-age context. Younger students in Grades 5-6 can be combined with older students if they have a good general understanding of the narratives and overarching story of the OT.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7-12	Old Testament: Grades 7-12 2 times/week 30 min 2 times/week 30 min	The Student Bible Atlas, Revised Edition Old Testament Today NIV Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible: Bringing to Life the Ancient World of Scripture ESV Concise Study Bible

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Bible: Grades 7-8				
Old Testament: Grades 7-12	New Testament: Grades 7-8	Old Testament: Grades 7-12	Church History: Grades 7-9	Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8
Bible: Grade 9				
Bible History: Grade 9	Old Testament: Grades 7-12	New Testament: Grade 9	Old Testament: Grades 7-12	Church History: Grades 7-9
Bible: Grades 10-11				
Spiritual Formation: Grades 10-11	Old Testament: Grades 7-12	New Testament: Grades 10-11	Old Testament: Grades 7-12	Church History: Grades 10-12
Bible: Grade 12				
Spiritual Formation: Grade 12	Old Testament: Grades 7-12	New Testament: Grade 12	Old Testament: Grades 7-12	Church History: Grades 10-12



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Bible: Grade 12

☐ Make or purchase Bible journals for Old and New Testament studies (see some suggestions in the following course Extra Helpings: Bible: Grades 7-8, 9, 10-11, and 12).



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Old Testament: Grades 7-12



The Student Bible Atlas, Revised Edition



Old Testament Today



NIV Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible: Bringing to Life the Ancient World of Scripture



ESV Concise Study Bible



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Related Course Quick Links

- ∞ [Extra Helpings](#)
- ∞ bibleproject.com
- ∞ [Foundations \(See Section 6: Bible\)](#)

Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.



Old Testament: Grades 7-12

How To Teach



Prepare

Read the commentary to prepare.



Recap

Connect back to the previous lesson. Ask students to give a summary of what they remember. (Full narration is not necessary.)



Introduce

Use a picture, a map, or an engaging question to prepare students to receive the story. You may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

Read aloud from the Bible.



Narrate

Have the students narrate.



Share

Optional: Share something interesting from your preparation that will help shed light on the story.



Discuss

Give students an opportunity to share their thoughts on the story and any connections made.

Old Testament: Grades 7-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 1

Materials: Bible, Old Testament Today, notebook

→ INTRO (FOR GRADES 7-12)

This year you will be reading 2 Samuel, 1 Kings, 1 & 2 Chronicles, selections of Psalms, Proverbs, and Ecclesiastes. You will be reading the passages chronologically, or in the order of the events. "The goal of studying the Bible chronologically is not to replace the time-honored canonical arrangement, but instead to honor time as a setting in which the biblical record appeared. Readers who study the Bible this way will return to their traditional Bibles better equipped to read them. Acquiring a sense of the flow of the Bible's story will put flesh and blood on its message" (from Chronological Guide to the Bible).

1. Your ESV Concise Study Bible (Grades 7-8) or Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible (Grades 9-12) will have maps, articles, and notes to help you along the way. If you have a question about a specific verse, see if there is a note about that verse below the text.
2. Use your Student Bible Atlas or atlas in your Bible to locate places as needed.
3. We will also utilize Old Testament Today and the Bible Project website as a handbook for helping us understand the background information we need to be informed readers. Look up the chapter of the Bible book you are reading in OT Today for any interesting sections you have not read before. Similarly, do a search at the Bible Project Website for the book you are reading and see what interesting articles or videos they have available when you have time in a lesson.

→ VIEW

1. Throughout the year, you will watch short videos of Dr. John Walton, the co-author of OT Today. The videos were created specifically for Alveary students. We hope they help you understand the Bible better.
2. You will be reading selections from the Psalms throughout the year. Watch this video to learn more about the Psalms.

∞ Video Link: Overview of the Psalms

→ PRINT

You may want to print out the summary of the book to reference as you read selections from the Psalms.

∞ Image Link: Psalms Overview Poster

→ READ, NARRATE & RESPOND

1. OT Today p.367-370 "To understand what" - "individual and nation."
2. Psalms 79-82

The psalms are difficult to tie to a specific historical context. They are the worship songs of Israel and are intended to apply to the needs of all worshippers across time. Some psalms do have historical superscriptions that make it possible to associate them with specific events, but these make up only about 10% of all the psalms. Another criterion is to place the psalms ascribed to David (or Solomon or Moses) during the life of that person. A second criterion is to place Psalms according to their type (from the Chronological Guide to the Bible).

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: Bible Project Overview of the Psalms

WEEK 1 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 2

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms last time?

→ INTRO

• EXTRA HELPING

Watch this summary of the whole OT in under 13 minutes.

∞ Video Link: OT Summary

Old Testament: Grades 7-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

Last year, we read through I Chronicles 16. Today, we will keep moving forward chronologically.

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Davidic Covenant

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

1. Read about 1-2 Chronicles p.223-224 in OT Today.
2. Psalm 83
3. I Chronicles 17

WEEK 2 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 3

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms and I Chronicles last time?

→ VIEW

When you read the Bible chronologically, you switch back and forth between 1-2 Samuel, 1-2 Chronicles, and 1-2 Kings. Dr. Walton will explain what the differences are between those books, even though they are telling about the same time period.

∞ Video Link: Differences Between Two Accounts of Israelite History

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

1. Read about 1-2 Samuel in OT Today p.204-208.
2. Psalm 88
3. 2 Samuel 8-9

WEEK 2 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 4

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms and 2 Samuel last time?

→ READ & VIEW

1. OT Today p.12-15 "A plotline traces" - "these three terms."
2. ∞ Video Link: Big Ideas and Plotlines

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

- 2 Samuel 10-11

WEEK 3 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 5

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in 2 Samuel last time?

→ READ & VIEW

1. OT Today p.19-21 "Confidence in the Results" - "hermeneutics are insufficient."
2. ∞ Video Link: Defective Views of God

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

1. 2 Samuel 12
2. Psalm 51

Old Testament: Grades 7-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 3

30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 6

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms and 2 Samuel last time?

→ READ & VIEW

1. Read OT Today p.9-12 "Most people come" - "the Old Testament."

2. ∞ Video Link: Tapestry Illustration

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

2 Samuel 13

SAMPLE